

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 5 4

♥ 9 6

♦ K Q 10 9

♣ Q 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ K 7 4 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ A 10 5



♠ K 6 3

♥ Q J 10 8 3

♦ J

♣ K J 6 2

♠ Q 10 9 8

♥ A 5

♦ 7 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by North

entry to dummy you must save it until the right time.

Win the first trick with the ♥K. Then play ♠A followed by ♠2. Continue playing ♠s until the ♠K is forced out. Win whatever they play next and play your other winners. You cannot be stopped from taking 7 tricks.

Imagine what would have happened if you had taken the first trick with dummy's ♥A.

What would you try next? A ♠ finesse? Whether East took his ♠K right then or later you would go down. You could never reach dummy again.

You have 7 points so you know your side does not have a game. You also have no reason to think there is any better contract than 1NT. So you pass.

South would play 1NT. To make life more convenient the hands will be rotated so that North becomes declarer.

North plays 1NT. East leads the ♥Q.

North plays 1NT. East leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

You need two more winners. Even if the ♦s split 3-2 you can get only one more from that suit. So clearly you must use the ♠ suit. Since you have only one

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ 8 6

♣ J 7 5 3 2



♠ 9 8 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 10 7 4 2

♣ A K 9 6

♠ Q J 5

♥ A J 10 9 6 3

♦ A K 5

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

It's a good thing you stopped at game - partner's hand is about as bad as it could be.

The PLAN turns out simple. You can't avoid either of the three black losers so you must eliminate the ♦ loser. You can ruff it in dummy. Just to be safe you pull one more round of trumps, then play ♦A, ♦K and ♦5, ruffing in dummy. You will eventually get to your hand (with a ♠ or a ♣ ruff) and pull the last trump.

This PLAN was not difficult.

Only a real beginner would have pulled all the trumps and not been able to ruff that ♦.

You have a nice hand, but 20 points is not strong enough to open 2♣.

So you open 1♥. Partner raises to 2♥.

Partner's raise to 2♥ shows 6-10 points. You figure that should be enough for game but even if he has the full 10 you are not in slam range. So you bid the game.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠A, then switches to ♥2.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠A, then switches to ♥2.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 5

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 6 5 3

♥ Q 9 7 4

♦ 10 8

♣ 9 7 4

♠ A 9

♥ A J 2

♦ Q J 3

♣ J 10 8 6 2



♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 10 8 6

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A 5

♠ 7 4

♥ K 5 3

♦ A K 9 6 2

♣ K Q 3

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

North

1♣

1NT

East

Pass

Pass

South

1♦

3NT